DoCC FINAL ACADEMIC SUBMISSION

Sangat

Sanjhi Soch, Sunehra Kal

Launching a Sustainable Basmati *Rice Brand for MVS*

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SPJIMR · Development of Corporate Citizenship · 2026 · with Manav Vikas Sansthan



From understanding communities to building *a market-linked opportunity.*

ACT I

01

Organisational immersion

MVS, its programmes and field teams

ACT II · THE GROUND

02

Field immersion

Chandpur, Fatehgarh Sahib, farmers

03

Institutional exposure

Punjab Agricultural University visit

ACT III · THE MARKET

04

Problem discovery

Linking field insight to a market problem

05

Market research

Stores, shoppers, retailers and rivals

ACT IV · SANGAT

06

Brand development

Name, identity, packaging, QR story

ACT V · PATHWAY

07

Implementation blueprint

GTM, operating model and pilot roadmap

FROM THE FIELD



Village household visit



Poplar nursery, Fatehgarh Sahib



Conversation with a farmer



Punjab Agricultural University



Retail and competitor study

MVS: an ecosystem, *not just an organisation.*

1996
Founded as a non-profit

5
States: Punjab, Himachal Pradesh, Haryana, Uttarakhand and Meghalaya

WHERE MVS WORKS

Women empowerment · sustainable agriculture · water conservation · climate resilience · education · rural development — with farmers, rural households and SHGs.

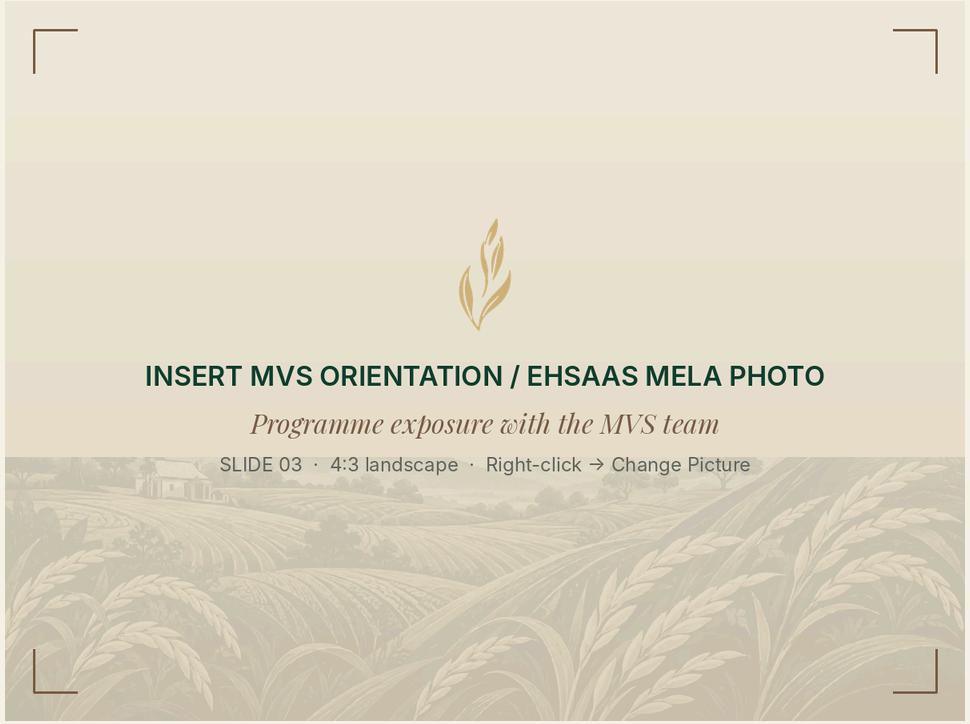
PRANA and PRERANA

PRERANA strengthens women-led institutions and farm and non-farm livelihoods; both programme teams facilitated our field interactions.

HOW OUR UNDERSTANDING EVOLVED

An NGO profile → Its programmes → Its people

We learned most from the relationships field teams have built with farmers and women.



Orientation and programme exposure with the MVS team

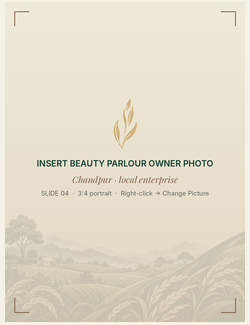
Source: MVS project report, §2 and Acknowledgement

Chandpur: the skills are there — *market access is the gap.*



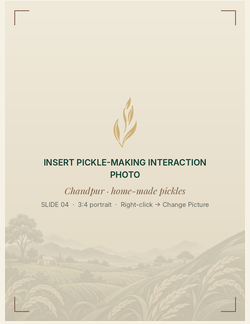
Field immersion: conversations in a village home, beyond formal meetings

Team field observations, Chandpur



A beauty-parlour owner

A local service business run from the village: women's entrepreneurship and income generation already at work.



A grandmother and pickle-maker

Highly skilled; her pickles have been supplied for corporate events. Skill like this needs steady market access to last.

WHAT CHANDPUR TAUGHT US

Capability is not the constraint — the link between *skills, markets and steady income is.*

ACT II · FATEHGARH SAHIB

Fatehgarh Sahib: entering the *agricultural ecosystem.*

At the Harit Punjab Plantation Nursery, **Akshay Sir** walked us through nursery processes, the initiatives under way, the stakeholders involved and their outcomes.

FIRST EXPOSURE TO

01 Nursery processes, saplings and inputs

02 Farming practices on the ground

03 MVS's role alongside farmers

Long before a grain is sold, many hands and decisions have already shaped it.



Harit Punjab Plantation Nursery



Walking the poplar plantation rows

INSERT AKSHAY SIR NURSERY WALKTHROUGH PHOTO

Fatehgarh Sahib · nursery processes

SLIDE 05 · 4:3 landscape · Right-click → Change Picture

Nursery walkthrough with Akshay Sir

Team field visit, Fatehgarh Sahib





ACT II · THE FARMER'S PERSPECTIVE

Gurdeep Singh: *farming as an enterprise.*

~15
acres of basmati, on owned and leased land

~5
years working with MVS

₹60 lakh
invested in agricultural machinery

Leases
machinery to other farmers in the area

Has **progressively adopted sustainable farming practices** over his years of working with MVS.

Approximate, farmer-reported figures shared during field discussions; not independently verified.

WHAT WE TOOK AWAY

Sustainable adoption sits inside a business: land, *machinery, investment, risk.*

Discussion with a basmati farmer · farm machinery

Field discussion, Punjab

Sustainable practice has to *pay for the farmer.*



Group discussion with basmati farmers



Understanding sustainable cultivation practices

WHAT FARMERS WEIGH

Basmati or Parmal
Which paddy to grow, and its yield

Input and lease costs
Cost of cultivating, and of leased land

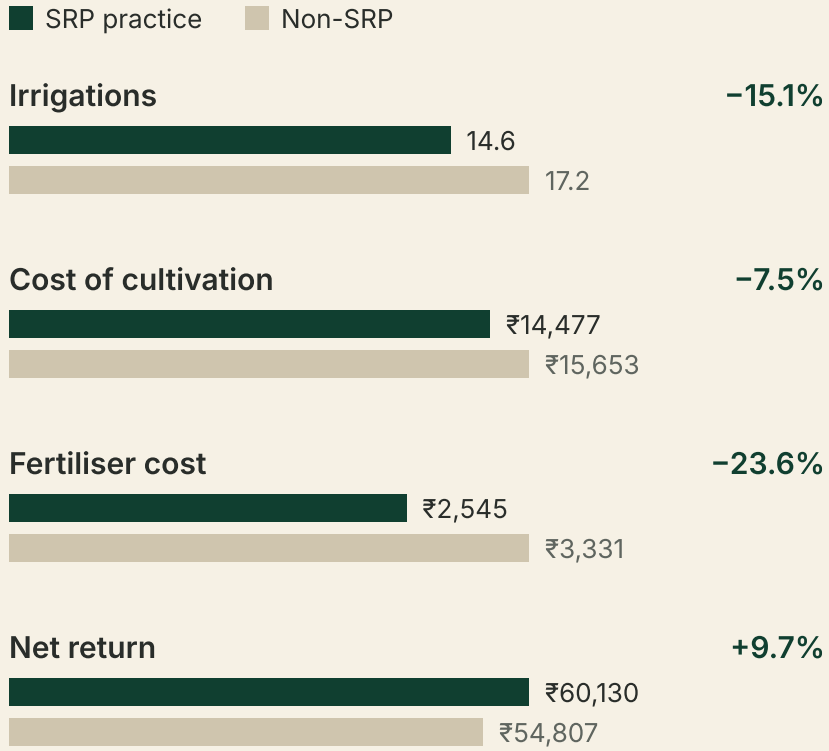
Pesticide use
How much is applied, and at what cost

Price uncertainty
No MSP for basmati; market-led price

Arthiyas
Dependence on commission agents

Risk of changing practice
Whether a new method pays off

MVS DATA · SRP vs NON-SRP, PER ACRE



Source: MVS SRP vs non-SRP comparison. Season, location and number of farms not stated — read as directional.

Practices must be **environmentally responsible and economically viable.**

Themes from farmer discussions are qualitative; MVS figures are per acre

ACT II · INSTITUTIONAL EXPOSURE

Punjab Agricultural University: where *research meets the field.*

Facilitated by the MVS project coordinator, the visit showed us MVS-related projects, agricultural equipment and operations — rice milling, processing and packing.

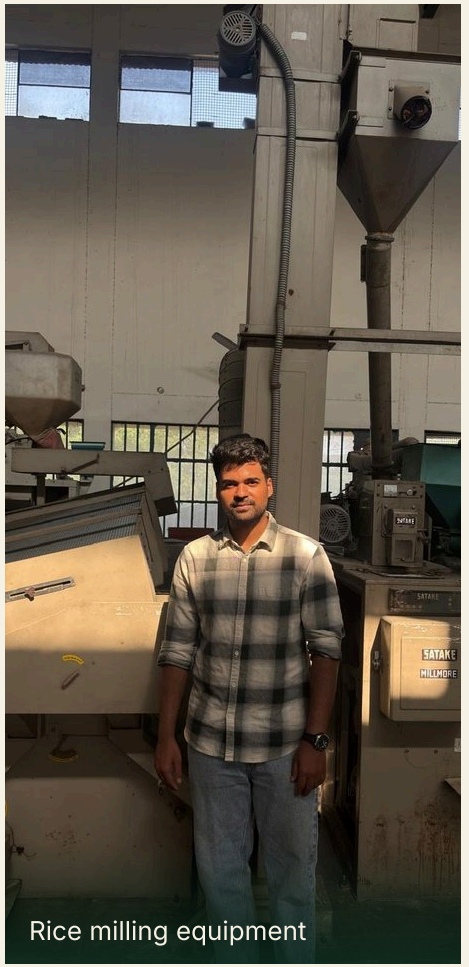
> WHY IT MATTERED FOR SANGAT
>
> *Milling, grading and packing are the steps a consistent branded rice relies on.*



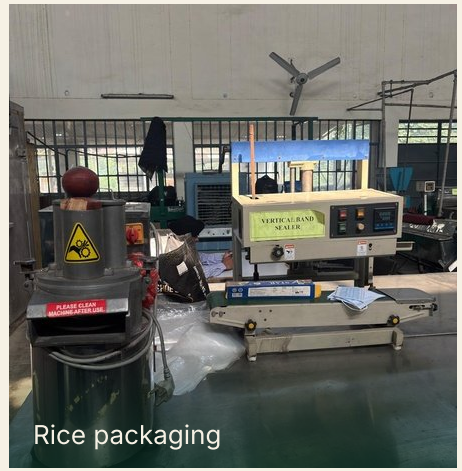
PAU campus, Ludhiana



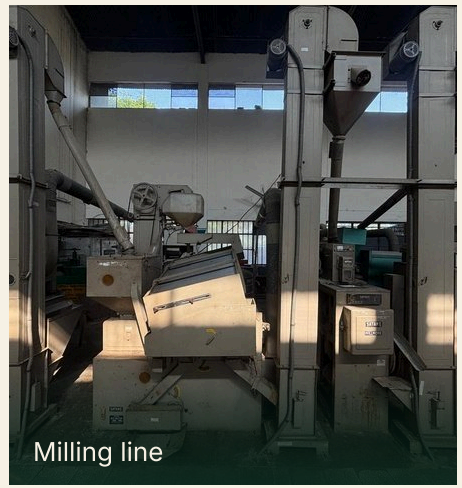
Agro-processing complex



Rice milling equipment



Rice packaging


Milling line

HOW THE PIECES CONNECT · OUR READING

Agricultural research → **Institutional support** → **Field-level adoption** → **Farmer livelihoods**

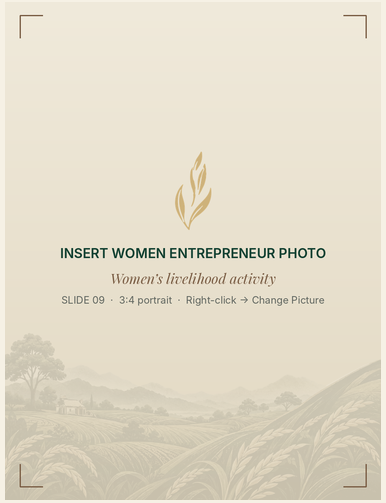
Knowledge and technology | Infrastructure, equipment, guidance | What farmers can actually use | Income and resilience

Team visit to Punjab Agricultural University, facilitated by MVS

Women's livelihoods: from skills *to sustained income.*



SHG interaction



Women's livelihoods

THE LEARNING

Skill development alone may not be enough without *market access and economic opportunity.*

Team interactions with SHG members and women in the communities

WHAT OUR INTERACTIONS SHOWED

01 **Entrepreneurial skills already exist**
Service and food-making skills are already earning, as in Chandpur.

02 **Income generation is the hard part**
Turning a skill into regular earnings remains a challenge.

03 **Access to markets**
Reach to buyers shapes what a skill can earn.

04 **Collective institutions**
SHGs and women-led groups give individual effort scale.

THE CONVERSION PATH · OUR READING



An existing farmer ecosystem.
An opportunity to build a consumer-facing proposition.

WHAT THE FIELD SHOWED

Agricultural sustainability
Nursery, farms, PAU

Farmer economics
Farmer discussions

Supply-chain coordination
Milling and packing at PAU

Consumer trust
Store and consumer visits

Product consistency
The premium buyer's first test

Market access
Chandpur and SHG interactions

THE PROBLEM WE WORKED ON

How can MVS translate its engagement with farmers and sustainable cultivation into a *credible premium basmati brand* — with product, sourcing story, operating model and proposition aligned?

Problem statement, MVS project report §1.2

THREE REQUIREMENTS

Product reliability
Can the same quality be supplied across batches?

Evidence and communication
Can the cultivation story be backed by farm, season and sourcing records?

Operating viability
Can supply, processing, packing and selling costs support the price?

A brand can make MVS's farming work visible — but only if product, evidence and operations align.

Synthesis of field immersion; problem and requirements from MVS project report §1.2 and §5.2

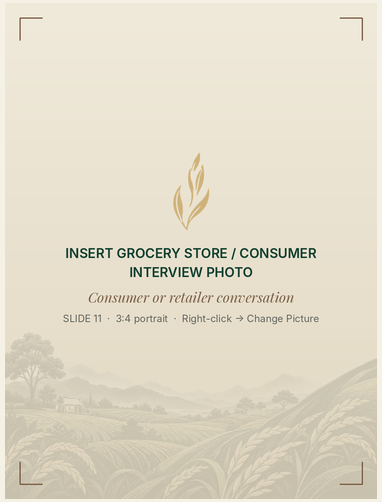
Buyers choose the cooking outcome first — *the story comes second.*



Shelf and pack study



Premium retail models



Consumer conversations

WHAT WE DID

Grocery and premium-store visits; a study of competitor products, packs and premium positioning; conversations with consumers and retailers on how they buy basmati and how they see sustainably grown food.

THE SWITCHING PROBLEM

A household that already buys premium basmati knows how its rice will cook. A new brand is a small but real risk when guests are coming or a family meal depends on it. **Product confidence** is the barrier.

WHAT BUYERS JUDGE FIRST

- **Aroma**
- **Grain length and quality**
- **Texture after cooking**
- **Cooking consistency**
- **Price**
- **Trust in the brand**

IMPLICATION FOR SANGAT

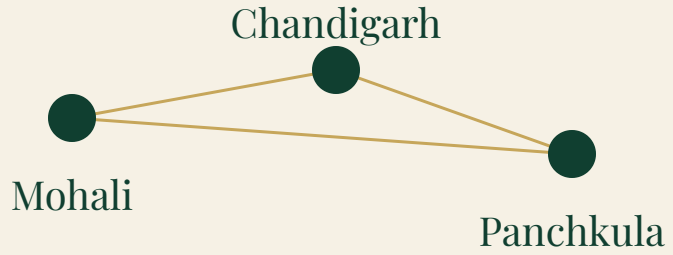
Meet the category's quality cues first — *then invite buyers to learn how the rice is grown.*

Exploratory market research; MVS project report §6

Start with buyers who already pay *for premium basmati.*

SEGMENT	MAIN NEED	ROLE FOR SANGAT
Informed Providers	Reliable aroma and texture with credible cultivation information	**Primary target** hypothesis; cooks at home, asks about origin
Assured Regulars	Consistent results across repeated home meals	Core premium pool; hard to win from trusted incumbents
Gathering Hosts	Confidence for biryani, pulao, festivals and guests	**Secondary**, occasion-led trial segment
Organic Purists	A product meeting an explicit organic specification	Not targeted unless the product meets that specification
Everyday Value Buyers	Lowest acceptable cost per kg	Not targeted at premium launch

PILOT GEOGRAPHY



Chosen for feasibility: the team had local access and could learn closely. Not a claim that these cities hold the largest demand.

Next: Delhi NCR, once quality, repeat purchase and service feasibility are shown.

PROPOSED POSITIONING · CONDITIONAL ON A WRITTEN SPEC AND COOKING TESTS

For households that already buy premium basmati and care how their food is grown, **Sangat** is the premium basmati from farming communities, developed with MVS, that delivers dependable aroma, grain and cooking results — and lets you see how the rice was grown.

MVS project report §7; segments are behavioural hypotheses, not sized markets

Sangat: a name rooted *in togetherness.*

Sangat

Sanjhi Soch, Sunehra Kal

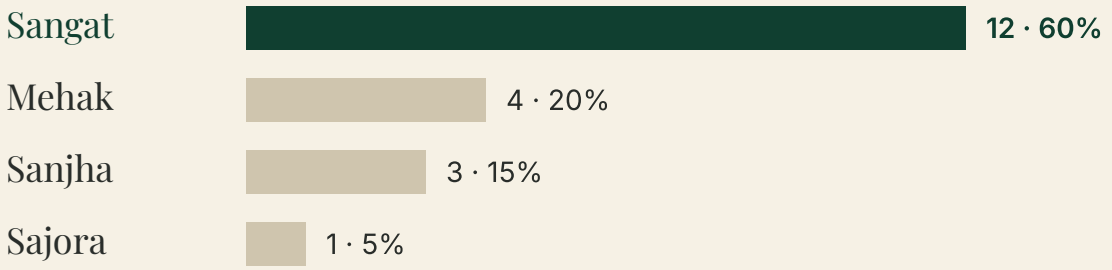
THE IDEA

Sangat — company, togetherness: farmers, MVS and households, connected through the food they grow and cook.

Sanjhi Soch, Sunehra Kal — shared thinking for a brighter tomorrow.

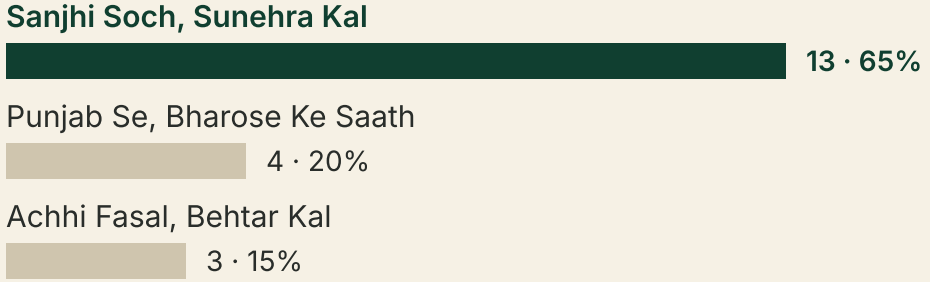
Uses the broad meaning of togetherness; no religious iconography.

NAME PREFERENCE · n = 20 (12 CONSUMERS, 8 RETAILERS)



Sangat led with consumers (7 of 12) and retailers (5 of 8).

TAGLINE PREFERENCE · n = 20



Exploratory: a small sample without recruitment details. It supports the working name and tagline; it does not establish purchase intent or willingness to pay.

Naming and tagline research, MVS project report §8.3–8.5; cultural note §9.3

ACT IV · VISUAL IDENTITY

One identity system: *forest, ivory and a golden ear of rice.*

A customised Playfair-style wordmark with a golden rice-ear motif and a sweeping underline, in primary, horizontal, stacked, wordmark and symbol-only versions.

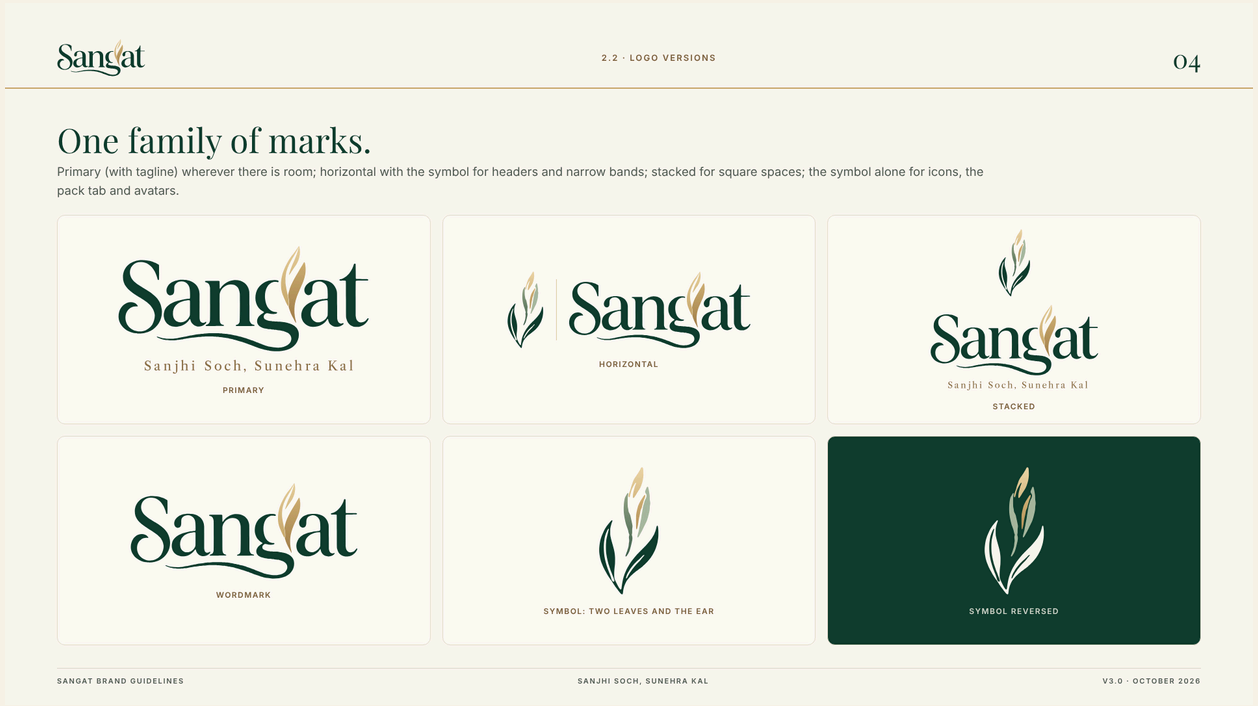
BRAND VALUES

Togetherness
Farmers, MVS and households

Care
Respect people and resources; no pity stories

Craft and consistency
Specification, cooking, pack quality

Honesty
Say only what records support



COLOUR

Forest Green #0F3D2E

Ivory #F9F6EE

Sunehra Gold #C9A96B

Earth Brown #8B6F47

TYPOGRAPHY

Aa **Playfair Display**
Expressive brand moments

Aa **Inter**
Information and utility

Forest anchors, ivory breathes, gold is a restrained accent.

MVS project report §8.6, §9; Sangat brand guidelines

Packs that lead with the product — *and invite the story.*

FRONT PANEL

Wordmark, tagline and descriptor lead; a landscape illustration links to cultivation; net quantity sits at the base.

BACK PANEL

A short brand story, the QR invitation and space for product and statutory information.

TWO FORMATS, ONE HIERARCHY

A 1 kg trial pack and a 5 kg family pack keep the same information order.

Concepts: specifications and the QR code are placeholders until MVS confirms them.



1 kg trial pack · front

5 kg family pack · front

Back panel with **QR story**

Premium basmati first; the farming story on the back and the QR.

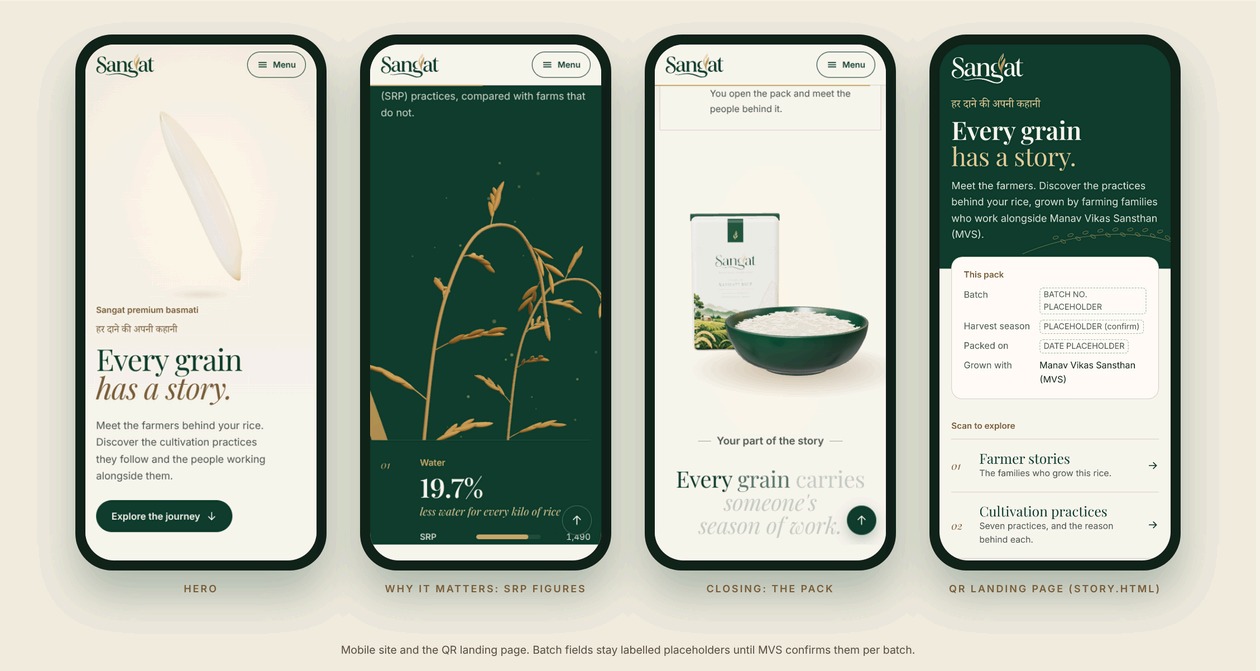
A QR story that says only *what records support.*

THE CONSUMER JOURNEY · CONCEPT

Scan the pack → **Story page** → **What is known**

Scan the pack	Story page	What is known
QR area on the back panel	Mobile-first page: what MVS does	Documented practices; product or batch facts

It links buyers to MVS's work and the journey behind the rice.



Website and QR landing-page direction — prototype design

WHAT WE DESIGNED

A design concept and website direction

A mobile story page that explains MVS's work and the practices that are documented, in plain language. The QR code in the concept is a placeholder, to be replaced with a tested HTTPS destination before printing.

WHAT IT IS NOT — YET

Not an operational traceability system

A programme-level farmer story does not prove that a named farmer grew the rice in a given packet. Farm-level traceability can be promised only if chain-of-custody records support it.

Go-to-market: prove the rice first, *then build trust in the story.*

01 Product

A **written specification** — grain length, ageing period, moisture, broken grain and purity limits — with processing and batch controls held constant across batches, plus cooking guidance for the dishes buyers actually make.

02 Price

~₹180–₹220 per kg

Indicative range from point-in-time retail listings, which vary by platform, city and pack size. Stay at competitor level: **the same quality at the same price**. Recheck listings before fixing the price.

03 Place

Pilot in **Chandigarh, Mohali and Panchkula**: selected premium grocery and modern trade; e-commerce and quick-commerce where feasible; direct ordering through the website or messaging; early sampling through MVS's community networks. General trade later.

04 Promotion

Cooking demonstrations and blind sampling; retailer education; recipe-led content for biryani and pulao; the QR story; hoardings, banners and leaflets in popular areas. The front of pack stays focused on the product.

Recommendations, MVS project report §11; prices are directional and time-sensitive

A brand is a chain of people *that must work together.*

MVS · COORDINATION, GOVERNANCE AND BRAND OVERSIGHT

Programme coordination · evidence governance · brand oversight · claim approvals · grievance escalation · clear ownership

01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08
Farmers	Farmer groups / arthiyas	Processors / millers	Quality lead / laboratory	Packaging vendor	Logistics partner	Retailers / online channels	Consumers
Cultivation, field records, agreed practices	Aggregation, volumes, lot IDs, primary records	Milling, grading, sorting, batch consistency	Testing and release checks to a written standard	Food-contact packs, approved artwork, quality checks	Storage and movement of finished packs	Availability, display, feedback, sell-through data	Buy, cook and judge — and decide whether to repeat

What the shopper sees as one pack is a sequence of hand-offs that must connect reliably.

Each hand-off needs clear guidance, written specifications, lot identification and reconciliation — the coordination MVS would own.

The next step is not to communicate louder — *it is to validate more carefully.*

01 · BEFORE LAUNCH

Prove the product

- Product specification and batch consistency
- Farm, season and sourcing records
- SRP status and approved claim wording
- Packaging compliance; every placeholder replaced

02 · IN THE PILOT

Prove the proposition

- Consumer comprehension of the message
- Paid trial, including cooking parity
- Repeat behaviour
- Retailer acceptance

03 · THE NUMBERS

Prove the model

- Supply volumes and landed cost
- Fulfilment cost and retailer margin
- Working-capital requirement
- Contribution margin

04 · DECISION



Go — build on the foundation; Delhi NCR could follow

Adjust — let the pilot show what needs to change

Stop — if the evidence does not support the proposition

IMMEDIATE PRIORITY

Appoint one accountable brand owner and a small cross-functional working group.

Bounded pilot in Chandigarh–Mohali–Panchkula; record negative as well as positive feedback · MVS project report §13–15

Ten outputs for MVS — *and what comes next.*



Team working session: brand and pack design

NOT YET DONE — AND NOT CLAIMED

Commercial launch or retail distribution
Consumer validation or repeat purchase
Verified farm-to-pack traceability
SRP product verification

01 **Brand identity**
Name, tagline, purpose, values, voice

02 **STP strategy**
Five segments; primary and secondary

03 **Exploratory naming research**
20 respondents; names and taglines

04 **Logo and visual identity**
Wordmark, rice-ear symbol, palette

05 **Packaging concepts**
1 kg and 5 kg; front and back panels

06 **QR storytelling concept**
Back-panel QR and story page

07 **Website direction**
Mobile-first prototype design

08 **GTM recommendations**
4Ps and pilot channel mix

09 **Stakeholder coordination model**
Eight roles under MVS oversight

10 **Implementation roadmap**
Validation sequence, decision gate

A foundation for linking MVS's farmer ecosystem to a market — once validated.

MVS project report, Executive Summary and §13

What the journey *taught us.*

1 **Development cannot be understood entirely from a desk.**

Learned in village homes, nurseries and fields — not in meetings alone.

2 **Farmer adoption depends on economic viability and practical realities.**

Learned from farmers weighing costs, prices, arthiyas and risk.

3 **Local capabilities need market access to become livelihoods.**

Learned in Chandpur and in our interactions with SHG members.

4 **Institutions, communities and markets must work together.**

Learned at PAU and through MVS's programme and field teams.

5 **A credible consumer proposition needs evidence, consistency and trust.**

Learned from shoppers, retailers and the work of building Sangat.



Sanjhi Soch, Sunehra Kal.

"Building a credible brand is not just about what reaches the consumer.
It is about the people, practices and partnerships behind every grain."

Ashish Satpathy | Janardhan Reddy Bogireddy

With thanks to the MVS field and programme teams, and to the farmers and community members who gave us their time; and to the DoCC team and SPJIMR for their guidance.

